

Grammar Lesson Plan 1

Topic: Present Perfect vs. Simple Past
Course: Academic A Grammar (ELC)
Instructor: Shantona Mir
Duration: 1 hour

1. Context Description

This lesson is designed for students enrolled in **Academic A Grammar** at the English Language Center (ELC).

- **Proficiency level:** Intermediate Mid to High (ACTFL).
- **Age:** 18–45 years.
- **Number of students:** 22.
- **Purpose for learning English:** Academic study in the U.S. and transition to mainstream university courses.
- **Prior knowledge:** Students have some idea about simple past tense forms (regular and irregular) but are not proficient user of the tenses. However, they are familiar with basic time expressions like *yesterday*, *last week*, *two years ago*, etc

Linguistic Need

- Academic A students often struggle to distinguish between *Past Simple* (completed action with a time reference) and *Present Perfect* (experience or ongoing relevance). These tenses are frequent in academic contexts such as reporting research, discussing personal experiences in interviews, and expressing achievements or life events.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

1. Accurately **recognize and differentiate** Present Perfect and Simple Past forms and meanings in spoken and written contexts.
2. **Use** both tenses appropriately in oral communication to express experiences, completed actions, and personal or academic narratives.
3. Develop **awareness of how time reference affects tense choice** in authentic discourse.
4. Build **fluency and automaticity** through communicative, real-time interaction rather than mechanical drills.

Stage	Activity (Step-by-step)	Time	Objective	Purpose	Pedagogical Rationale	Materials
P – Presentation	Review, Hook & Modeling – “What day is it again?” + Modeling 1. I will begin with a 2-minute warm-up where students write down one thing they did yesterday that they are grateful for today. 2. Students turn to a partner and share their sentence. 3. As students share, I will walk around and listen for natural use of past tense . 4. Model sentences to the class: “I went to my friend’s house yesterday.” “I’ve been to my friend’s house many times.” “I’ve been to Mexico three times.” 5. Ask students: “Which of these sounds like something I did once, and which sounds like something that’s part of my life experience?” 6. I will let them react and share their guesses, ideas that they are known with. 7. Draw a simple timeline on the board and gesture to show difference between specific time and life	10 min	- Activate prior knowledge. - Elicit natural use of past tense. - Provide contextualized input for Present Perfect vs. Simple Past. - Encourage initial noticing.	Build a meaningful context where students naturally notice the contrast in tense use before explicit explanation.	Inductive Grammar Teaching, Krashen’s Affective Filter Hypothesis , low-stakes sharing supports noticing without pressure.	Whiteboard, marker, candy reward, timeline sketch

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A – Attention	experience, without giving formal grammar rules yet. Tense Detectives (Dialogue Analysis) 1. I will say : “ <i>You noticed how my sentences felt different. Now let’s see how other people use these tenses.</i> ” 2. Distribute a short printed dialogue between two people (e.g., talking about travel experiences). Example: A: “Have you ever been to New York?” B: “Yeah, I went there last year.” A: “Oh really? I’ve always wanted to visit.” 3. In pairs, students underline all verbs in the dialogue. 4. Ask them to sort the sentences into two groups: anchored events (Simple Past) and life experiences (Present Perfect) . 5. Students discuss in pairs: “ <i>Why do you think some sentences use one tense and some use the other?</i> ” 6. I will circulate to listen in, I will prompt deeper noticing but not explain rules yet. Timeline Mapping 1. I will draw a large timeline on the board with points for specific times (e.g., yesterday, last year) and space above it for general experiences. 2. Call on students to share some sentences from the dialogue. 3. As they share, I will write or place each sentence either <i>on</i> the timeline (anchored past) or <i>above</i> it (floating/life experience). 4. Ask prompting questions: “ <i>What’s similar about the sentences on the line?</i> ” / “ <i>What’s different about the ones above?</i> ” 5. Students work in pairs for 2 minutes to formulate a “rule” in their own words. 6. Elicit student explanations, then clarify and formalize the grammatical distinction (Simple Past = anchored events; Present Perfect = experiences or continuing relevance). 7. I will then add key time expressions under each category.	15 min	- Guide students to notice tense use in authentic input. - Push them to analyze meaning– form relationship.	Provide structured noticing, preparing students for rule articulation later.	Schmidt’s Noticing Hypothesis ; input enhancement facilitates awareness of tense contrast.	Printed or projected dialogue, pens/highlighters
	C – Co-construction	15 min	- Help students articulate and internalize the conceptual difference. - Build metalinguistic awareness collaboratively.	Move students from noticing to shared understanding through guided pattern discovery.	Sociocultural Theory (Vygotsky) – peer scaffolding; Inductive Grammar Teaching .	Whiteboard, markers, timeline, sticky notes or sentence strips
E – Extension	Interview with a Legend / Mini Life Stories 1. I will say: “ <i>Now that you know how these tenses work, let’s use them to tell stories and ask questions.</i> ” 2. They will get to choose	20 min	- Enable students to apply tense knowledge in structured and freer communication. - Build fluency and	Reinforce conceptual understanding through authentic communicative tasks.	Task-Based Language Teaching (Ellis); Krashen’s Affective Filter Hypothesis – communicative output fosters fluency and retention.	Interview prompt cards, timer, optional sentence stems

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	which group wants to do what. Option 1: Students work in pairs. One plays a “legend” (celebrity, scientist, athlete), the other is a journalist. They must ask 4 Present Perfect questions and 4 Simple Past questions (e.g., “Have you ever won a prize?” / “When did you first compete?”). 3. Option 2: Students tell a mini life highlight story using at least 2 Present Perfect and 2 Simple Past sentences. Partners ask follow-up questions. 4. I will walk around to monitor language use and support accuracy through recasts or prompts. 5. End with 1–2 volunteers sharing highlights with the class, and summary of the lesson.		confidence in real-time use.			